

● FREE CLASSROOM RESOURCE

The Morning Meeting Starter Packet

31 ready-to-use greetings, sharing prompts, group activities, and morning message templates — print it, laminate it, or keep it on your desk for the first month of school.

Greetings

The first two minutes of your day set the tone for everything after. These greetings take under 3 minutes and work for any grade band — rotate through them so morning meeting never feels repetitive.

1

Name & Wave

Each student says their name and does a wave move of their choice as it travels around the circle.

2

Would You Rather Welcome

Partners ask each other a quick "would you rather" question before saying good morning.

3

High Five Train

Students greet both neighbors with a high five and "Good morning, [name]!" — keeps energy up on Mondays.

4

Compliment Circle

Each student gives the person next to them one genuine compliment before saying good morning.

5

Silent Ball Pass

Pass a soft ball around the circle with eye contact and a silent nod instead of words — great reset for a loud morning.

6

Two Truths Greeting

Each student shares one true fact about themselves as part of their greeting.

7

Number Check-In

Students greet with a show of 1–5 fingers indicating how they're feeling — a quick, wordless emotional check-in.

8

Handshake of the Day

Teach a simple 3-step handshake pattern (clap–tap–snap); students use it to greet three neighbors.

Sharing Prompts

Sharing builds classroom community — but a blank "does anyone want to share?" rarely gets a real answer. Use a specific prompt instead. Pick one, go around the circle, or let students choose a partner.

1 What's one thing you're looking forward to today?

2 Share a time you helped someone this week.

3 If you could have any animal as a pet, what would it be and why?

4 What's your favorite thing to do outside?

5 Tell us about something that made you laugh recently.

6 What's one small goal you have for today?

7 Share one thing you're proud of from this week.

8 If you could visit anywhere in the world, where would you go?

9 What's your favorite book or story right now?

10 Tell us about a person in your family you admire.

Quick Group Activities

Fast, whole-class energizers that need zero prep and zero materials — most take 3–5 minutes. Use one after sharing to transition the room from "circle time" back to "learning mode."

1

Silent Line-Up

Line up by birthday month, height, or first letter of name — without talking. Great focus reset.

2

Categories Clap

Name a category (fruits, animals, cities). Go around the circle naming one item each on a steady clap rhythm, no repeats.

3

Would You Rather Vote

Pose a would-you-rather question; students vote by moving to one side of the room. Ask a few why.

4

Mirror Movement

Pair up. One partner leads slow movements for 30 seconds while the other mirrors silently, then switch.

5

Group Count-Up

As a class, count to 20 one number at a time with no assigned order — if two people speak at once, start over. Builds listening.

6

Pass the Clap

A clap pattern is passed around the circle as fast as possible without breaking rhythm.

7

Yes, And... Story

Build a group story one sentence at a time — each student's sentence must start with "Yes, and..."

8

Human Bingo

Hand out a 4-square card; students find a classmate who matches each square before the meeting ends.

Morning Message Templates

Write one of these on your board or project it before students arrive. Fill in the blanks with your day's actual plan — it takes 60 seconds and gives early arrivals something to read and think about.

TEMPLATE 1 — THE STANDARD

Good morning, _____! Today is _____. We will start with _____ and then move to _____. I'm excited about _____ today!

TEMPLATE 2 — BUILDING ON YESTERDAY

Good morning! Yesterday we learned about _____. Today we'll build on that by _____. Get ready to _____!

TEMPLATE 3 — THE RIDDLE OPENER

Happy _____! Here's a riddle to start your brain: _____. Think about it during morning meeting — we'll share guesses.

TEMPLATE 4 — WORD OF THE DAY

Good morning, scholars! Today's focus word is: _____. It means _____. Try to use it at least once today.

TEMPLATE 5 — SPECIAL DAY

Good morning! We have a special day today: _____. Here's what to expect: _____, _____, _____.

WANT THIS BUILT FOR YOU, EVERY DAY?

You just used the manual version. Here's the **automatic** one.

Every day, OfTheDay builds a fresh, balanced Morning Meeting — greetings, sharing, group activities, and a message — so you never have to build one from scratch again. Free plan available, no credit card required.

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